

ENGLISH LANGUAGE

LEVEL C1

Master precise, nuanced and strategically effective communication

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CEFR-Based English Language Curriculum Designer

Curriculum structure • authentic tasks • projects • differentiation • assessment • portfolio

From advanced competence to sophisticated analysis, synthesis and rhetorical control

Framework note: proficiency progression is grounded in the CEFR-level document supplied by the user. English-specific grammar, phonology, lexical sequencing and tasks are a pedagogical adaptation created for English.

Pedagogical vision - Level C1

An advanced curriculum for precise meaning, implicit interpretation, stylistic flexibility, complex synthesis and confident participation in demanding academic, professional and social discourse.

1. Exit profile

By the end of C1, the learner can understand a wide range of demanding, longer texts and discourse, including implicit meaning and stylistic effects; express ideas fluently and spontaneously; use language flexibly for social, academic and professional purposes; produce clear, well-structured, detailed texts on complex subjects; and manage nuance, register and rhetorical effect with high control.

2. Core competence targets

- Reception: understand long, complex and abstract discourse, recognise implicit meaning, stance, allusion, style and secondary points, even when topics extend beyond personal specialisation.
- Production: produce sophisticated arguments, analyses, syntheses, creative texts and presentations with precise organisation, nuance and appropriate register.
- Interaction: participate actively in demanding discussions, take and hold the floor, challenge, reframe, negotiate and respond to subtle interpersonal cues.
- Mediation: condense, restructure and recontextualise complex information for different audiences, reconcile perspectives and clarify conceptual relationships.
- Language control: command advanced syntax, lexical precision, collocation, idiomaticity, register, rhetorical devices, discourse organisation and prosodic nuance.

3. Annual progression map

Unit	Theme	Main communicative goal	Signature performance
1	Register, Voice and Precision	Control register, connotation and rhetorical voice across contrasting genres.	Rewrite and perform the same message for three different audiences.
2	Society, Ethics and Contested Questions	Construct sophisticated ethical arguments while representing competing positions fairly.	Write and defend a nuanced policy or ethics position paper.
3	Geopolitics, Economics and Complex Systems	Explain and synthesise complex social, economic or geopolitical developments.	Deliver an expert-style briefing with scenario analysis.
4	Literature, Rhetoric and Style	Analyse sophisticated texts and experiment deliberately with style.	Produce a critical commentary and creative transformation.
5	Humour, Irony and the Unsaid	Interpret and use implication, humour, understatement and indirectness appropriately.	Create and analyse a satirical or pragmatic communication piece.
6	Research, Expertise and Public Communication	Conduct a substantial inquiry and communicate it expertly to different audiences.	Complete the C1 International Academic Conference.

4. Pedagogical principles

- Action-oriented learning: every language focus is linked to a communicative purpose and a visible performance.
- Integrated skills: listening, reading, spoken interaction, spoken production, writing and mediation are combined rather than taught in isolation.
- Spiral progression: key structures and lexical fields reappear with greater complexity and independence.
- Pronunciation for intelligibility: accuracy is developed through rhythm, stress, connected speech and high-value contrasts, without requiring imitation of one single native accent.
- Evidence-based learning: portfolio artefacts, self-assessment and performance tasks document progress across the level.

Unit 1 - Register, Voice and Precision

Choose exactly the language the situation requires

Communicative outcomes	Distinguish subtle register differences; choose precise synonyms/collocations; manage formality and interpersonal stance; analyse how voice shapes meaning.
Grammar & functions	Inversion; cleft/pseudo-cleft structures; ellipsis/substitution; advanced fronting; complex prepositional patterns; sophisticated reference and cohesion.
Vocabulary	Register, connotation, idiomaticity, collocation, euphemism, understatement, intensifiers, nuanced synonymy, formal/informal/academic/professional phraseology.
Pronunciation	Fine control of prominence and de-accenting; discourse rhythm; stance intonation; pausing to mark information structure; accent of insistence.
Integrated skills	Analyse register in authentic texts/audio; transform genre; edit for precision; present versions aloud; explain lexical/rhetorical choices.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Register continuum with authentic excerpts.
- Collocation surgery: replace "possible but unnatural" combinations.
- Same message: text message, formal email, public statement.
- Voice analysis: certainty, distance, authority, warmth.
- Read-aloud workshop on information focus and rhetorical stress.

Authentic performance task

"One Message, Three Voices": produce three versions of the same content for contrasting audiences and justify linguistic/pragmatic choices in a commentary.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Register checklist, collocation dictionary guidance, annotated models and teacher conferencing on high-impact choices.
Expected level	Consistent register and precise lexico-grammatical choices with clear rationale.
Extension	Imitate a distinctive genre/voice, then critique the ethical or interpersonal consequences of those choices.

Evidence of learning

- I can adapt register consistently to audience, purpose and genre.
- I can choose precise vocabulary and collocations to express fine distinctions.
- I can recognise how voice and information structure shape interpretation.
- I can use prosody to signal stance and emphasis deliberately.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 2 - Society, Ethics and Contested Questions

Argue with nuance under conditions of uncertainty

Communicative outcomes	Frame complex questions; distinguish empirical and value claims; qualify generalisations; articulate ethical tensions; anticipate and answer counterarguments.
Grammar & functions	Advanced modality and evidentiality; mixed/counterfactual conditionals; concessive inversion; hedging/boosting; extraposition and impersonal stance structures.
Vocabulary	Ethics, rights, responsibility, fairness, risk, autonomy, public interest, evidence, trade-offs, unintended consequences, values and principles.
Pronunciation	Stance and attitudinal intonation; controlled rhetorical emphasis; strategic pause before qualification; calm delivery under challenge.
Integrated skills	Read essays/op-eds; map arguments; synthesise ethical frameworks; write a 700-900 word paper; defend it in seminar discussion.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Fact/value/assumption sorting.
- Hedging audit of overgeneralised claims.
- Ethical dilemma roundtable with rotating frameworks.
- Counterargument pre-mortem: predict the strongest objection.
- Policy paragraph clinic: claim → evidence → limitation → implication.

Authentic performance task

“Ethics Position Paper”: nuanced written argument plus 6-minute oral defence and questioning, explicitly acknowledging limitations and competing values.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Argument map, stance language inventory, curated readings and structured seminar roles.
Expected level	Sophisticated, balanced argument with precise qualification and coherent response to counterarguments.
Extension	Reframe the argument from an opposing ethical perspective and identify what evidence could change the conclusion.

Evidence of learning

- I can distinguish evidence, assumption and value judgement in complex argument.
- I can qualify claims and generalisations precisely.
- I can represent an opposing position fairly before responding.
- I can defend a nuanced position under sustained questioning.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 3 - Geopolitics, Economics and Complex Systems

Interpret relationships, data and competing explanations

Communicative outcomes	Interpret trends and causality cautiously; compare explanations; discuss systemic effects; summarise specialised information for non-specialists; build scenarios.
Grammar & functions	Nominalisation and dense noun phrases; complex reporting structures; advanced cause/concession/condition; participle and reduced clauses; sophisticated tense/aspect for historical analysis.
Vocabulary	Economy, policy, institutions, trade, inequality, migration, conflict/cooperation, governance, indicators, trends, systemic risk, scenario and causality.
Pronunciation	Pacing dense content; prominence hierarchy (main vs supporting points); clear delivery of figures; parenthetical phrasing; authoritative but non-dogmatic tone.
Integrated skills	Read specialised but accessible reports; interpret charts; listen to expert commentary; synthesise perspectives; write briefing note; present scenarios.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Causation vs correlation language audit.
- Data-to-narrative transformation.
- Three-explanation synthesis: where do experts agree/disagree?
- Briefing note compression: 800 words → 250 words.
- Scenario planning: baseline, optimistic, adverse.

Authentic performance task

“Strategic Briefing”: 7-minute expert-style presentation with data, multiple explanations, uncertainties and two plausible future scenarios.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Glossary, data-commentary phrases, briefing template and curated source dossier.
Expected level	Accurate synthesis and disciplined distinction between evidence, interpretation and prediction.
Extension	Critique source assumptions/methodology and respond to specialist-level follow-up questions.

Evidence of learning

- I can synthesise complex factual and analytical material.
- I can distinguish causation, correlation, interpretation and prediction.
- I can explain specialised information to a non-specialist audience.
- I can use dense academic/professional structures without losing clarity.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 4 - Literature, Rhetoric and Style

Interpret how form creates meaning

Communicative outcomes	Interpret narrative voice, symbolism, irony and rhetorical devices; compare style across texts; support literary interpretation; imitate or transform a style.
Grammar & functions	Narrative tense/aspect refinement; literary inversion/fronting; complex relative structures; rhetorical parallelism; punctuation and sentence rhythm as stylistic resources.
Vocabulary	Literary analysis, rhetoric, imagery, tone, register, motif, symbolism, irony, ambiguity, narrative perspective, rhythm, metaphor and allusion.
Pronunciation	Expressive reading; rhetorical rhythm; pause and tempo; contrast between neutral reading and interpretive performance; nuanced intonation.
Integrated skills	Close-read literature/essays; annotate style; compare passages; write critical commentary; perform and justify a creative transformation.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Rhetorical device detective.
- One paragraph, three interpretations.
- Style imitation workshop.
- Sentence rhythm editing: periodic vs cumulative effects.
- Comparative commentary planning from two excerpts.

Authentic performance task

“Style Laboratory”: 700-word critical commentary plus a creative rewrite/pastiche and short reflection explaining stylistic choices.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Annotation codes, rhetorical glossary, model commentary structure and guided close-reading questions.
Expected level	Text-based interpretation with precise terminology and coherent stylistic analysis.
Extension	Engage with ambiguity, intertextuality or critical perspectives and defend an original interpretation.

Evidence of learning

- I can analyse how style and rhetoric create meaning.
- I can support an interpretation with precise textual evidence.
- I can recognise irony, ambiguity and implicit meaning.
- I can manipulate syntax and rhythm deliberately in my own writing.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 5 - Humour, Irony and the Unsaid

Understand pragmatic meaning beyond literal words

Communicative outcomes	Infer speaker intention; recognise irony/sarcasm; interpret allusion; manage politeness and indirectness; analyse why the same utterance can mean different things.
Grammar & functions	Pragmatic uses of modality; ellipsis; tag questions; rhetorical questions; inversion and marked word order; discourse particles/markers in spoken English.
Vocabulary	Humour, irony, sarcasm, understatement, hyperbole, implication, face-saving, politeness, ambiguity, allusion, stance and interpersonal nuance.
Pronunciation	Irony and attitudinal intonation; pitch range; deliberate under-stress/over-stress; timing; contrast between literal wording and prosodic meaning.
Integrated skills	Interpret dialogue/film extracts; identify implicature; compare spoken/written humour; write satirical or indirect messages; explain pragmatic risks.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Literal or implied? dialogue analysis.
- Same words, five intonations.
- Politeness redesign: direct → tactful → over-polite.
- Satire anatomy: target, exaggeration, incongruity, audience.
- Cross-cultural misunderstanding case study.

Authentic performance task

“Meaning Between the Lines”: short satirical/pragmatic piece plus analytical commentary explaining linguistic and prosodic cues and possible audience interpretations.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Curated examples with context, pragmatic cue checklist, transcript-plus-audio comparison and explicit discussion of cultural variability.
Expected level	Accurate interpretation of common implicit meanings and deliberate, context-sensitive production.
Extension	Analyse subtle humour across cultures/genres and evaluate when ambiguity is strategically useful or risky.

Evidence of learning

- I can infer implied meaning from context, wording and intonation.
- I can recognise and explain irony, understatement and rhetorical effect.
- I can use indirectness and politeness strategically.
- I can anticipate how different audiences may interpret the same message.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 6 - Research, Expertise and Public Communication

Synthesize, recontextualise and defend complex knowledge

Communicative outcomes	Define a research problem; evaluate sources; synthesise complex evidence; write extended academic/professional text; present and defend conclusions; recontextualise for another audience.
Grammar & functions	Full-system refinement according to needs; advanced cohesion; syntactic compression/expansion; source integration; sophisticated punctuation; genre-sensitive tense, modality and reporting choices.
Vocabulary	Research methodology, evaluation, limitation, implication, conceptual frameworks, specialised terminology, academic phraseology, metadiscourse and presentation language.
Pronunciation	Conference delivery; rhetorical stress; pace variation; signposting; handling interruptions/questions; concise repair and reformulation in real time.
Integrated skills	Research within approved sources; annotate; synthesise; write 1,000-1,500 words; create abstract; present 8-10 minutes; respond to sustained Q&A; produce public summary.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Research question and scope clinic.
- Source quality and limitation review.
- Synthesis paragraph workshop across 3+ sources.
- Abstract writing and peer selection.
- Mock conference Q&A with progressively difficult questions.

Authentic performance task

“International Academic Conference”: research paper, abstract, 8-10 minute presentation, formal Q&A and 250-word public-facing summary for non-specialists.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Research milestones, source evaluation rubric, writing conferences, model abstracts and rehearsal with recorded self-analysis.
Expected level	Precise, well-structured synthesis and confident defence of a complex argument with appropriate register.
Extension	Chair a panel, respond to cross-disciplinary critique and revise the paper after formal peer review.

Evidence of learning

- I can research and synthesise complex information from multiple credible sources.
- I can write a well-structured extended text for an academic or professional audience.
- I can present complex findings fluently and respond to challenging questions.
- I can recontextualise specialised knowledge clearly for a different audience.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Integrative project and assessment

International Academic Conference

1. Project brief

Each learner investigates a complex topic in ethics, AI, education, environment, geopolitics, economics, media, culture, science or literature and produces a substantial source-based paper, conference presentation, formal Q&A and public-facing synthesis.

2. Project stages

1. Define a focused research question, scope and intended audience.
2. Build an annotated source set and evaluate credibility, perspective and limitations.
3. Draft a synthesis-based paper with a defensible argument and explicit qualification.
4. Write a conference abstract and design a concise visual support.
5. Present for 8-10 minutes and respond to sustained questioning.
6. Revise one section after peer/expert feedback and produce a 250-word public summary.

3. Assessment architecture

Assessment moment	Evidence
Diagnostic	B2/C1 bridge task: complex article/talk synthesis, 350-word argument and seminar discussion to identify precision, register and implicit-comprehension needs.
Formative	Research conferences, lexical/collocation logs, rhetorical analysis, advanced pronunciation coaching, peer review, synthesis checks and reflective commentary.
Performance	Register transformation, ethics defence, strategic briefing, literary/style analysis, pragmatic task and conference rehearsal.
Summative	C1 integrated assessment combining demanding reception, source synthesis, extended writing and a 12-15 minute presentation/discussion.
Portfolio	Research notes, two substantial revised texts, recorded seminar/presentation evidence, lexical/pronunciation reflection, peer feedback and final conference package.

4. Common performance rubric

Criterion	Observable evidence
Task achievement	Completes the communicative purpose and responds to all essential parts of the task.
Range & accuracy	Uses level-appropriate grammar and vocabulary with errors that do not compromise the intended message.
Coherence	Organises ideas with sequencing and linking appropriate to the level and genre.
Interaction / mediation	Responds, clarifies, reformulates, supports turn-taking and/or relays information appropriately.
Pronunciation / delivery	Speaks intelligibly, using progressively appropriate stress, rhythm and intonation.

Implementation guide

Resources, differentiation, routines and exit indicators

1. Recommended classroom resources

- Learner portfolio: diagnostic sample, drafts, corrected productions, recordings, project evidence and self-assessment.
- Dictionaries: visual/bilingual support at lower levels; increasingly monolingual, collocation and learner dictionaries from B1 upward.
- Coursebook: any institution-approved CEFR-aligned English coursebook; exact page numbers must be mapped after the school selects its edition.
- Worksheets: information gaps, reading/listening organisers, pronunciation grids, peer-feedback checklists, writing frames and reflection sheets.
- Authentic input: menus, maps, notices, websites, podcasts, interviews, short articles, videos and literature adapted to age and level.

2. Lesson routine

Phase	Pedagogical use
Opening	Activate prior knowledge, retrieve previously learned language and connect it explicitly to the lesson purpose.
Input	Notice meaning and form through a short text, audio, image, model dialogue or teacher demonstration.
Guided practice	Rehearse the target language with scaffolds, controlled interaction and pronunciation focus.
Main task	Students use the language to solve a problem, exchange information, create a product or communicate a real message.
Reflection & closure	Students complete an observable "I can..." check, submit an exit ticket or record one piece of evidence in the portfolio.

3. Differentiation model

Pathway	Examples
Support	Visuals, word banks, sentence stems, chunked input, slower audio, guided notes, rehearsal time, peer support and reduced output load.
Core	Independent completion of the expected communicative task using authorised resources and standard time.
Extension	Less scaffolding, wider vocabulary, extra constraints, spontaneous follow-up questions, source comparison, mediation or leadership roles.

4. Exit indicators - Level C1

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| ☐ I can understand long, demanding texts and speech, including implicit meaning and stylistic effect. | ☐ I can distinguish subtle differences in stance, register, connotation and rhetorical purpose. |
| ☐ I can synthesise complex information from multiple sources without oversimplifying. | ☐ I can write precise, well-structured texts for academic, professional and creative purposes. |
| ☐ I can express and defend nuanced positions fluently, including under challenge. | ☐ I can adapt language, tone and organisation flexibly to audience and genre. |
| ☐ I can mediate complex ideas by condensing, restructuring and recontextualising them. | ☐ I can use pronunciation and discourse intonation strategically to support meaning, emphasis and interpersonal stance. |

C1 principle: strategic mastery - advanced competence is demonstrated not by complexity alone, but by precision, flexibility, audience awareness and control of meaning.